

Deal 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 5
♥ 7 3
♦ T 9 3
♣ A K J 6 2

13
8 7
12

♠ K Q J 4 2

♥ K 5

♦ A 5 2

♣ 7 5 3



♠ A 7 3

♥ Q J T 8 2

♦ K 8 6

♣ Q 4

♠ T 9

♥ A 9 6 4

♦ Q J 7 4

♣ T 9 8

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 1

NORTH's 2

♦

bid is New Minor Forcing.

NORTH chose

♦

s rather than ♣s simply

because the

♦

s were stronger.

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♦

Pass

1NT

Pass

4 ♠

2 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 8 4
♥ K Q 8 4
♦ Q 5 2
♣ 7 6 3

6
8 16
10

♠ A T 9 6 2

♥ 5

♦ T 9 7 3

♣ Q T 4



♠ Q 7 3

♥ T 7 3

♦ J 8 6 4

♣ A K 9

♠ K 5
♥ A J 9 6 2
♦ A K
♣ J 8 5 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

3♥

3♣

Pass

All Pass

3♥ by East

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 2

EAST is unlikely to win 10 tricks if WEST has three ♣ losers.

EAST's 3♣ bid is a Help Suit Game try.

With no help in ♣s and no ruffing values, WEST's 8 points are

not enough to think of game, so WEST signs off in 3



Deal 3

South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 4 3
♥ A 3
♦ 7 5 3 2
♣ 9 6 5 2

14
6 7
13

♠ K 8
♥ Q 8 5
♦ J 8 4
♣ A K J 7 3



♠ A J 7 6 2
♥ K T 9 4
♦ K Q 6
♣ 4

♠ T 9 5
♥ J 7 6 2
♦ A T 9
♣ Q T 8

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

s stopped so she bids 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 3
NORTH's 3

♦

bid is Fourth Suit Forcing and

does NOT show a

♦

stopper.

The bid asks SOUTH to further describe her hand.

SOUTH does not have a rebiddable suit, but does have

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 7
♥ A Q 5
♦ K T 9 4 3
♣ K T 7

11
12 10
7

♠ A J T 3

♥ J 4

♦ J 8 6 5

♣ A 9 6

N
W E
S

♠ K 4

♥ K T 9 8 2

♦ 7 2

♣ J 5 3 2

♠ Q 9 6 5 2

♥ 7 6 3

♦ A Q

♣ Q 8 4

West

1 ♦

1NT

2NT

All Pass

2NT by West

♥

s.

But he does have

♥

s stopped, so bids 2NT. East is not strong

enough to bid game so she passes.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 4

EAST cannot rebid the 5-card ♠ suit, cannot support WEST's

♦

s,

and cannot bid Notrump without a

♥

stopper.

So she bids 3♣, New Minor Forcing, asking WEST to describe his hand further.

WEST doesn't have three ♠s, nor does he have four

Deal 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J
♥ Q 9 8 2
♦ Q 8 5 2
♣ A Q 9 8

14
11 8
7

♠ A K T 6 2

♥ A 4 3

♦ K 9 6 4

♣ 7



♠ Q 5 4 3

♥ 7 5

♦ A J T 3

♣ 6 5 2

♠ 9 8 7

♥ K J T 6

♦ 7

♣ K J T 4 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 5

NORTH's 3

♦

bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has excellent help in

♦

s

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

so with 8 points he bids the game.

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 8 3
 ♥ A Q J 7
 ♦ J 9
 ♣ K T 2

6
 14 13
 7

♠ K 9 6 4 2

♥ 9 2

♦ 8 3

♣ Q J 9 7



♠ 7

♥ K 8 6 5 3

♦ A T 6 5 2

♣ 5 4

♠ A T 5
 ♥ T 4
 ♦ K Q 7 4
 ♣ A 8 6 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 6

WEST has no reason to consider New Minor
Forcing with this hand.

EAST does not have four



s or he would have already supported, and

he does not have four ♠s or he would not have
bid 1NT.

So WEST should bid the Notrump game.

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	1 ♦	Pass
3NT		1NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Deal 7

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ J T 2
♦ K 5 2
♣ K 9 8 3

13
7 8
12

♠ K 6 4
♥ K Q 9 7 4
♦ 4
♣ A J 6 5



♠ A Q 9 7 2
♥ 8 5
♦ A 9 6
♣ Q T 4

♠ J T
♥ A 6 3
♦ Q J T 8 7 3
♣ 7 2

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 7

SOUTH might well bid 3NT at his second turn, and this may turn out to be the

final contract anyway.

But it doesn't hurt to bid 2



(Fourth Suit Forcing) just to

see if NORTH happens to have three ♠s. She does, so 4 ♠ becomes the better game.

Deal 8

West Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5
♥ Q J 9 7
♦ A Q 9
♣ A 8 4 3

8
13 13
6

♠ Q J 9 2
♥ A 6 5
♦ 8 6 2
♣ J 7 6



♠ T 4
♥ 3 2
♦ J T 7 5 3
♣ K Q T 9

♠ A K 7 6 3
♥ K T 8 4
♦ K 4
♣ 5 2

West	North	East	South
1♣	Pass	1♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
suit, and next show 3-card ♠ support.

Change WEST's



9 to the ♠9 and the contract would be 4♠.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 8

WEST isn't strong enough to make a Reverse
bid of 2



at his second turn.

EAST uses the 2



(NMF) bid to ask WEST for further
description.

WEST should first show a 4-card



Deal 9

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8 6 3
♥ A J 4 3 2
♦ A K
♣ 6 5 2

14
12 9
5

♠ A Q J T 7

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 3

♣ A K 8 4



♠ K 9 4 2

♥ 8

♦ 8 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9 7

♠ 5

♥ K Q T 9

♦ Q J T 9 6

♣ J T 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 9

NORTH's 3



bid is a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH barely had enough strength to respond in the first place, but revaluing the hand,

(and particularly the singleton



), makes it worth a

raise to game.

Deal 10

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ K T
♥ A 9 7 5 4
♦ K Q 6 2
♣ 9 6

8
12 13
7

♠ Q 8 6 2
♥ J 3
♦ A J T 3
♣ 7 5 2



♠ 9 4 3
♥ Q T 8 2
♦ 9 5
♣ K Q 8 4

♠ A J 7 5
♥ K 6
♦ 8 7 4
♣ A J T 3

West

1 ♥

2 ♦

All Pass

3NT by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

3NT

South

Pass

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 10

EAST has no reason to consider Fourth Suit Forcing with this hand.

WEST does not have four ♠s or he would have already supported.

So EAST should bid the Notrump game.

Deal 11

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q T 9 6 5 2

♥ J 4

♦ A J

♣ 8 4

8

11 9

12

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2



♠ A 7

♥ Q T 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A T 9 6

♠ 4

♥ K 5

♦ T 9 5 3 2

♣ K Q J 5 3

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 11

SOUTH should pass 2



. She is not strong enough to

try for game.

West

North

East

South

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

All Pass

2 ♥ by South

Deal 12

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ A T 7
♦ Q T 6 4 3
♣ A K 2

8
13 13
6

♠ 7
♥ 5 4 2
♦ A K J 7
♣ T 9 7 6 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 9 5 2
♥ 9 6 3
♦ 8 2
♣ J 5 4

♠ K Q T 6 3
♥ K Q J 8
♦ 9 5
♣ Q 8

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠	Pass
1NT	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West
bids 2NT, which East raises to 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 12

EAST knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠,

4

♥

or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and

bids 2♣ at her second turn.

WEST does not have a 4-card

♥

suit, nor does he have

three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he

Deal 13

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
♥ A 7 6 2
♦ Q T 3
♣ 9 8 6

16
6 10
8

♠ A J
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ A 5
♣ J 5 4 2



♠ K 5 3
♥ T 9 5 3
♦ 9 8 6 4
♣ K Q

♠ Q T 9 7 4
♥ -
♦ K J 7 2
♣ A T 7 3

West

Pass

All Pass

4♥ by North

North

1♥

3♣

East

Pass

Pass

South

2♥

4♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 13

NORTH cannot see a game unless SOUTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit Game Try.

SOUTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he bids the game.

Deal 14

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q T 3
 ♣ A K 5

5
 13 14
 8

♠ 7 6 3 2
 ♥ 8
 ♦ A J 8 5 2
 ♣ T 7 3



♠ K Q 4
 ♥ K 9 6 5 2
 ♦ 7 6
 ♣ 9 8 2

♠ A J T
 ♥ A Q T 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q J 6 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	1 ♣	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3NT	Pass
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 14

WEST has a perfect hand on which to use
 Fourth Suit Forcing. If East can stop

♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if WEST bids 1 ♠ at her
 second turn it is NOT considered

FSF, so she must jump to 2 ♠.

EAST, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

Deal 15

South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ T 9
♥ A
♦ Q J T 9 6
♣ T 9 8 6 2

12
7 8
13

♠ K 8 4 3 2
♥ K Q 8 3
♦ 7 3
♣ A 5



♠ Q 7 5
♥ J T 7 6
♦ A 8
♣ K Q J 3

♠ A J 6
♥ 9 5 4 2
♦ K 5 4 2
♣ 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	4 ♥		
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			

s is

first priority.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 15
NORTH's 2



bid is a perfect example of NMF.

It provides SOUTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card



suit,

OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand SOUTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the



Deal 16

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 9 7
 ♥ 8 7
 ♦ A K J 6 2
 ♣ T 2

9
 12 13
 6

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ T 9 4 3
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ K Q 7 3



♠ 4 2
 ♥ Q J 2
 ♦ Q 9 7 5 3
 ♣ J 6 5

♠ Q T 8 3
 ♥ A K 6 5
 ♦ T
 ♣ A 9 8 4

West	North	East	South
		1 ♣	Pass
1 ♦	Pass	1 ♥	Pass
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠	Pass
4 ♠			
All Pass			
4 ♠ by West			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 16

WEST's 1 ♠ bid is definitely forcing, but it is not FSF. In this one instance, all

bids at the one level, the ♠ bid shows a real suit.

So EAST shows the 4-card support and WEST bids game.

Deal 17

North Deals
None Vul

♠ K 8 5 3 2
♥ J 4
♦ K 4 2
♣ Q T 3

14
9 10
7

♠ A 6 4
♥ A K 9 7 2
♦ 7
♣ K 8 6 5



♠ 9 7
♥ Q 6 5 3
♦ T 8 3
♣ A J 7 2

♠ Q J T
♥ T 8
♦ A Q J 9 6 5
♣ 9 4

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 17

NORTH could make a Help Suit Game Try in either ♠s or ♣s.

But she doesn't need the ♠ help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent help in ♣s

so he bids the game.

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Deal 18

West Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K J T 5
♥ T 9 6
♦ K 7
♣ A Q J 3

7
14 13
6

♠ 9 7 4 3
♥ A Q 4
♦ J T 3
♣ 5 4 2



♠ A 8 2
♥ 7 3 2
♦ Q 6 2
♣ T 9 7 6

♠ Q 6
♥ K J 8 5
♦ A 9 8 5 4
♣ K 8

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	1 ♦	Pass
1 ♠	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			



suit and bid 3NT.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 18
Could EAST bid 2



, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so. WEST does not have four



s

or he would have mentioned them before bidding ♠s.

EAST should ignore the

Deal 19

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 7 2
♥ J T
♦ J T 4
♣ K J 9 6 2

13
6 9
12

♠ Q 5 4
♥ 7 6
♦ A K 9 8
♣ A 8 7 4



♠ A K T 6 3
♥ K Q 9 8 5
♦ 6 3
♣ 5

♠ J 9
♥ A 4 3 2
♦ Q 7 5 2
♣ Q T 3

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

4♠ by South

NORTH recognizes that SOUTH must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

North

1♦

2♣

4♠

East

Pass

Pass

South

1♠

3♥

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 19

SOUTH cannot bid 2



at his second turn; that would be

Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the



suit at all.

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3



instead.

Deal 20

West Deals
Both Vul

♠ Q 8 5
♥ A 5
♦ K Q J 6 2
♣ 6 4 3

7
12 11
10

♠ A J 4 3 2
♥ T 9
♦ 8 5 3
♣ Q 7 5

N
W E
S

♠ T 9
♥ Q 6 4 2
♦ T 7
♣ A K J T 8

♠ K 7 6
♥ K J 8 7 3
♦ A 9 4
♣ 9 2

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♥	Pass
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♦			
All Pass			
2♦ by West			

suit.

EAST has nowhere to go, so passes.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 20

EAST bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping
WEST has three

♥

s.

WEST does not have three

♥

s and he has no other bid to make that

will describe his hand any better. He cannot
bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper.

So WEST rebids the 5-card

Deal 21

North Deals
None Vul

♠ T 9 5
♥ T 8 6 2
♦ 5 3
♣ A K J 4

12
8 7
13

♠ 8 4
♥ A K 9 4 3
♦ A J 9 6
♣ 7 5



♠ A Q J 6 3
♥ Q J 5
♦ K 4
♣ T 9 2

♠ K 7 2
♥ 7
♦ Q T 8 7 2
♣ Q 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by North			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 21

SOUTH should not use Fourth Suit Forcing to see if NORTH holds three ♠s because

that information is irrelevant.

SOUTH already knows there is an 8-card



fit and enough

points to be in game so he bids it.

Deal 22

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 3
♥ 7 6 4 2
♦ K T 8 2
♣ Q 5

8
7 16
9

♠ 4
♥ A T 8
♦ A 9 7 6
♣ T 9 8 7 4



♠ T 7 5 2
♥ K Q 9
♦ Q J 5 4
♣ J 2

♠ A K J 8 6
♥ J 5 3
♦ 3
♣ A K 6 3

West

North

East

South

2 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

3 ♠

3 ♥

Pass

All Pass

3 ♠ by East

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 22

EAST thinks there might be game if WEST can help with the three



losers. So he bids 3



as a Help Suit Game Try.

WEST cannot provide any help at all, so quickly signs off in 3 ♠ which EAST passes.

Deal 23

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 7 4
♥ A 6 5 4
♦ Q J 5 2
♣ J T 3

13
8 9
10

♠ K 9 5
♥ K J 2
♦ A 9 6 3
♣ Q 6 4



♠ A J 8 6 2
♥ Q 9 3
♦ K 7 4
♣ 8 5

♠ Q T 3
♥ T 8 7
♦ T 8
♣ A K 9 7 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 23

SOUTH bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing,
hoping NORTH will show three ♠s.

NORTH does show three ♠s, but also shows a
minimum hand so South passes.

Deal 24

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 5
♥ T 4
♦ K Q 7 4
♣ K J 6 3

5
13 13
9

♠ J 4 3 2
♥ 8 3
♦ T 6 3
♣ A T 9 2

N
W E
S

♠ Q 8 6
♥ Q J 9 7
♦ A 5 2
♣ 8 7 4

♠ K T 7
♥ A K 6 5 2
♦ J 9 8
♣ Q 5

West	North	East	South
1♦	Pass	1♥	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			

s but confirms a ♠ honor by

bidding 2NT, so EAST bids the game in Notrump.

Baker Bidpractice/Set12 24

EAST wants to be in game but doesn't know which one.

If WEST holds three

♥

s she would prefer 4

♥

,

otherwise she would try 3NT. EAST bids 2♠, Fourth Suit Forcing.

WEST denies three